about China's increased assistance to the Naxalites, who had stepped up their activities in summer 1970.[104]

India left the door open to China, including through a "slightly more warm and less formal" national day greeting.[105] Despite deepening Sino-Pakistan relations—evident during Pakistani leader Yahya Khan's visit to China—Gandhi emphasized that Indian policymakers "should not colour our attitude to attempt to bring about a change."[106] Overall, however, as a contemporary report noted, while "one or two icicles have melted," there was no "thaw." An Indian official stated, "I don't think anything is going to go very far very fast."[107]

Thus India continued its efforts with its neighbors. India moved to demarcate its border with Burma despite potential domestic political objections because of concern about the "Chinese fishing in troubled waters."[108] Vis-à-vis Nepal, Haksar noted that India should handle the situation with "firmness but … courtesy, selectively pressuring the King," while clandestinely linking up with India-friendly Nepalese and probing the extent to which American, British, and Soviet policymakers "share our concern at the way the King is opening the country to Chinese penetration and influence."[109] India also hoped to deepen its bilateral relations with various countries in South and Southeast Asia, as well as develop regional economic cooperation.[110]

By fall 1970, fears of an imminent attack from China had receded, but, as Gandhi and other officials told Rogers, the China threat had not disappeared.[111] The premier reiterated her major concern to her British counterpart: "If Pakistan attacks us, China may join them."[112] Indian intelligence subsequently emphasized the continued challenge posed by Sino-Pakistan collusion.[113]

Thus India needed to maintain healthy relationships with the Soviet Union and the US. This, in turn, had consequences for the Sino-Indian relationship. Mishra asserted that Beijing saw India's relationship with the US as a key stumbling block to Sino-Indian rapprochement. Zhou blamed Washington for China's bilateral border conflicts, and Chinese officials had more of a problem with US "imperialists" than with Indian "reactionaries." The chargé felt China wanted to see from India "not so much coolness towards [the] Soviet Union as opposition to United States policies in South